

TIMELINE

1914 Born on March 26 in Saxon, South Carolina.

1936 Named first captain in his final year of studies. Graduates from the US Military Academy and is commissioned as a second lieutenant.

1936–39 Trains at Fort Sill, Oklahoma.

1939 Commands his first unit in Hawaii.

1942–45 During World War II, serves as battalion commander in North Africa, Sicily, France, and Germany.

1946 Takes command of 504th Parachute Infantry Regiment, 82nd Airborne Division.

1947–50 Serves as chief of staff for the 82nd Airborne Division.

1952 Joins the Korean War effort as a brigadier general.

1955–58 Promoted to secretary of the Army chief of staff.

1958–60 Promoted to commanding officer, 101st Airborne.

1960–63 Becomes superintendent at the US Military Academy.

January 1964 Made deputy commander of Military Assistance Command Vietnam (MACV). Becomes commanding officer of MACV in June of the same year.

1965 Appointed general; named Time magazine's Man of the Year.

1968 Returns to the US; promoted to US Army chief of staff.

1972 Retires from the US Army after 36 years of service.

1974 Leads an unsuccessful campaign for the Republican nomination to be governor of South Carolina.

1976 Publishes a memoir about his life entitled A Soldier Reports.

1985 Pursues a libel suit against a damning 1982 CBS documentary, which is settled out of court.

2005 Dies on July 18 in Charleston, South Carolina; buried at West Point.



ATTENDING A VETERANS' PARADE